



OFFICIAL NEWSLETTER
Arike Care

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COVER STORY · ERNAKULAM

Every skill can become an act of care

A beautician, a phone call, and a family who had waited months for someone to help safely.

01 · COVER STORY

Restoring comfort through compassionate care

Every person carries a skill that can ease someone else's burden.

The Arike team recently received a call from the family of a bedbound person living with Spinal Muscular Atrophy (SMA). His fingernails and toenails had not been trimmed for several months. An earlier attempt had resulted in an accidental cut and bleeding, leaving the family understandably worried about trying again.

The team remembered a conversation from several months earlier. During a visit to Arike, Dr. Sunil Kumar from IMA Cochin had mentioned that his wife, Padmaja, was a professional beautician who wanted to use her free time to support people who were unable to leave their homes.

When the Arike team reached out to Padmaja, she readily agreed. She visited the patient at home and, with patience and precision, trimmed, shaped and cleaned his fingernails and toenails, taking every precaution so that he felt no discomfort.



**“It's a wonderful feeling knowing a simple skill
can bring someone real relief.”**

Mrs. Padmaja Sunilkumar · volunteer

Her visit did not end with grooming. She spent time with the patient and his family, listened to their concerns, and offered practical advice. For the patient it was a small but meaningful restoration of comfort. For his family it brought relief after months of worry.

Care is not limited to medicines, procedures or clinical interventions. A beautician's skill, offered at the right moment, became a source of comfort, and helped restore a sense of normalcy and dignity.

“I just hope that by sharing this, others feel inspired to step forward and do the same,” she says.

VOLUNTEER DIARIES

സന്നദ്ധപ്രവർത്തകരുടെ കുറിപ്പുകൾ

Nafeesath · first visit with our team

This was my first experience in palliative care, and it really touched me. I realised that even in a small area there are many people who need care, support, and simply someone to be there for them. This experience has inspired me to learn more and contribute wherever I can.

02 · ACTIVITIES · AUGUST 2026

What we did this month

പ്രവർത്തനങ്ങൾ



7 August • 7th anniversary



Seven years beside our neighbours

Members, volunteers, supporters and well-wishers came together to mark seven years of community-based palliative care, and to reflect on our continued efforts to support families living with serious illnesses.

Vaduthala

EDAPPALLY ZONE

9 August

Edappally zone meeting

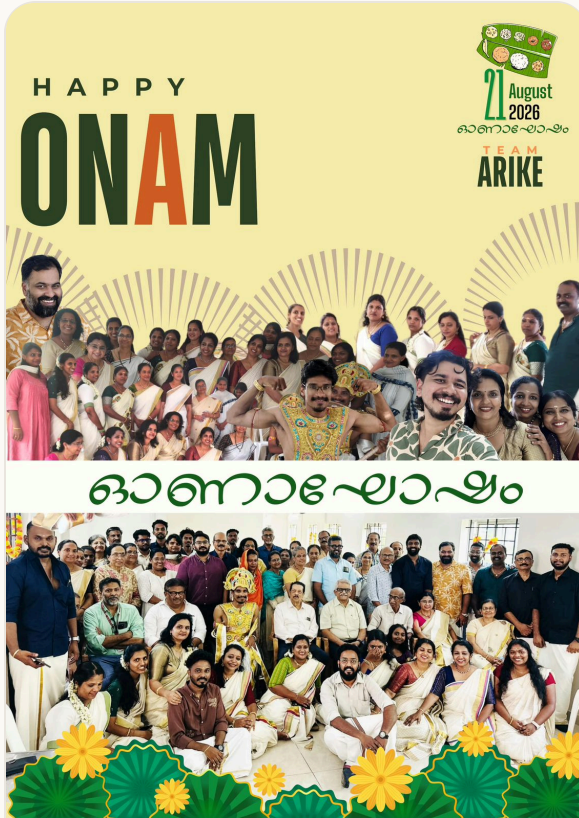


19 August

Onam kit campaign at the IMA

Team members and volunteers met to review activities and plan local initiatives.

Arike raised funds for the Onam kit initiative during the IMA general body meeting.



21 August

An Onam spent together

A pookalam, an onasadya and games brought volunteers, supporters and contributors together.

21

ONAM KITS DELIVERED

23 August

Food kits for families

Dr. Geetha, Arun, Donal and volunteers delivered food kits to families in need.



30 August

Sensitisation at Vyttila

Mr. Suhail and Mr. Donal introduced community-based palliative care at the Dr. Palppu Kudumba Unit of the SNDP Shakha.

Helping the patient stay hydrated

പരിചരണ കുറിപ്പ്

Adequate fluids help prevent dehydration and improve comfort. Offer small amounts of water or other preferred fluids often, rather than a large quantity at once.

- 01 Encourage the patient to drink whenever they are comfortable and able to.
- 02 Keep a cup or bottle of water within easy reach.
- 03 Offer fluids the patient enjoys, following their preference and the care team's advice.
- 04 Watch for signs of dehydration: a dry mouth, reduced urine, dark urine, or unusual weakness.
- 05 If the patient has difficulty swallowing, do not force fluids. Tell the care team instead.
- 06 Keep the lips and mouth moist for comfort, especially when they are drinking less.

Call the care team if the patient cannot drink at all, keeps vomiting, has difficulty swallowing, or shows signs of significant dehydration. Never force fluids.

04 · SUPPORT OUR CAUSE

Free care at home, paid for together

ഞങ്ങളെ പിന്തുണയ്ക്കുക

With your support, Arike provides free home-based palliative care to patients within the Kochi Corporation limits. On average our team cares for 40 patients every day, at home.

We also help with medicines, nutrition, and the educational needs of children. You can become a monthly supporter from **₹500 a month**.

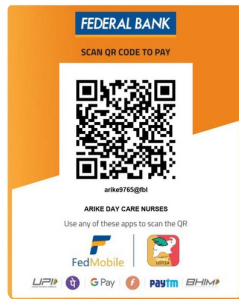
Give online

arikecare.org/donate



SCAN TO GIVE

SCAN TO GIVE · UPI



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IFSC **FDRL0001380**
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A vehicle with wheelchair access is available for travel at no cost to the family. Support our running costs and make every journey possible. For info, call **+91 7034 336999**.



A heartfelt thank you

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Every act of kindness becomes a source of strength for the patients and families we serve. Your contributions, big and small, help us deliver dignified care to people facing serious health-related suffering.

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